

Circuit Analysis (Lab3)

Experiment 3: Introduction to Multimeter and Basic Series Circuit Implementation

Name:

Registration No:

Date:

Grade and Signature:

CLO2	Use with identification the circuit components, breadboards, multimeters, power supplies, signal generators, and oscilloscopes.			
CLO3	Make measurements in their own constructed electric circuits.			
Psychomotor/Affective	Level1 (1)	Level2 (2-3)	Level3 (4-5)	Level4 (6-7)
Report Marks (3)			Total marks (10)	

Objectives: To get understanding of how to use a multimeter and make measurements in your own constructed series circuits.

Equipment required:

Power Supply, Breadboard, Connecting wires, Resistances, Multimeter.

What is a multimeter?

A multimeter is a measurement tool necessary in electronics. It combines three essential features: a voltmeter, ohmmeter, and ammeter, and in some cases continuity. A multimeter allows you to understand what is going on in your circuits. Whenever something in your circuit isn't working, the multimeter will help you troubleshooting.

Parts of Multimeter:

Display: this is where the measurements are displayed

Selection knob: this selects what you want to measure

Ports: this is where you plug in the probes

Probes: a multimeter comes with two probes. Generally, one is red and the other is black.

Note: There isn't any difference between the red and the black probes, just the color. So, assuming the convention:

- The black probe is always connected to the COM port.
- The red probe is connected to one of the other ports depending on what you want to measure.

Ports

The “COM” or “-” port is where the black probe should be connected. The COM probe is conventionally black.

- **A** is used when measuring large currents, greater than 200mA
- **mA** is used to measure current
- **VΩ** allows you to measure voltage and resistance and test continuity.

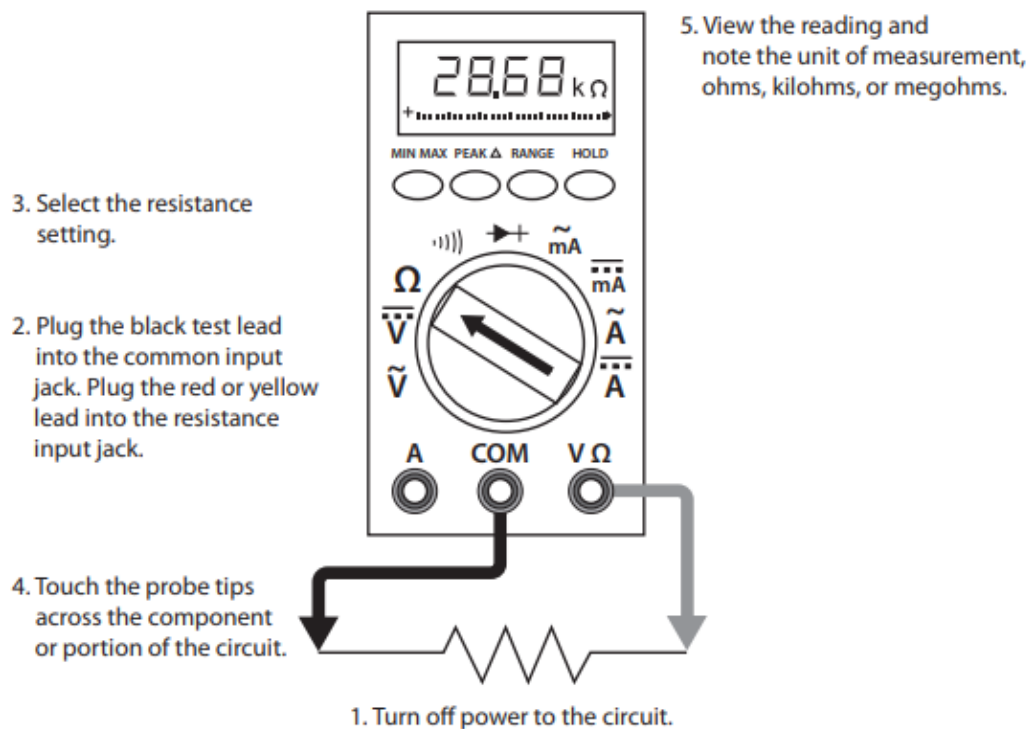


Figure 2 Using a DMM to measure resistance

Introduction to voltage measurements

Voltage measurements are very easy to make with a DMM. On meters with manual range selection, start with a value one setting higher than expected. An auto range DMM will automatically select the range based on the voltage present. Figure 4 shows the process.

Note:

1/ 1000 V=1mV

1000 V=1kV

Follow these steps to measure voltage:

1. Select the DC or AC volts function by turning the function switch to DC or AC volts.
2. Plug the test probes into the appropriate probe jacks.
3. Connect the tips of the probes across the source or load.
4. View the reading on the display unit. Be sure to note the unit of measurement. If you are testing DC voltage and a negative sign appears in the display, the polarity of your probes is incorrect and needs to be reversed.

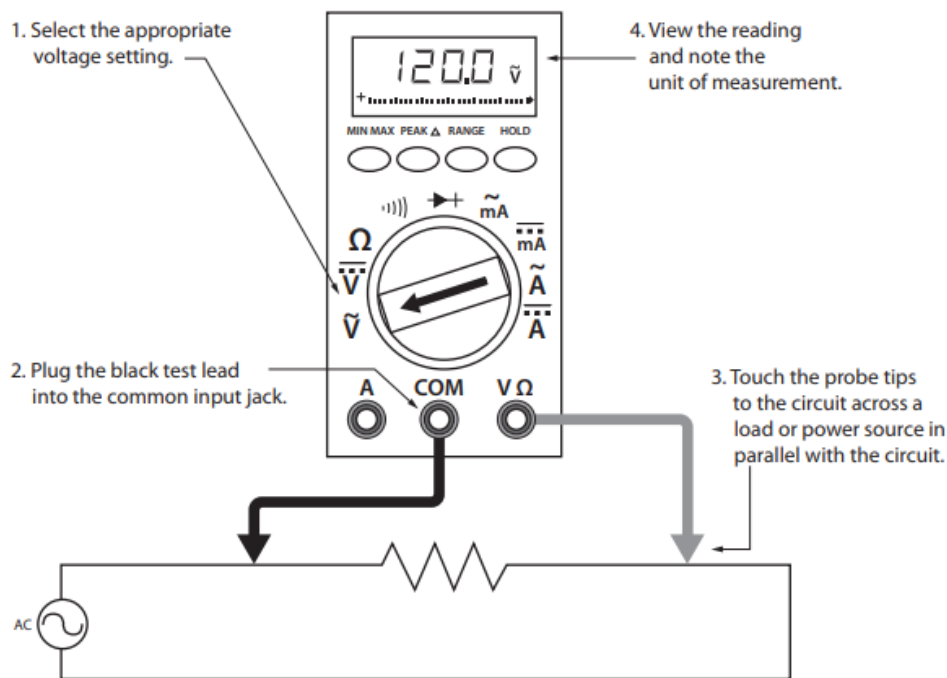


Figure 3 Using a DMM to measure voltage

Introduction to current measurements

As you have seen, the placement of meter leads for voltage measurements is straightforward. The leads are simply connected across, or in parallel with, the points of voltage to be measured. For current measurements, however, the process is slightly more complex.

First, the circuit must be opened at the test points and the meter inserted in series at that opening. The total current must flow through the meter. To allow the measurement to be made without disturbing the circuit itself, the current meter must have very little internal resistance.

If the meter is inadvertently connected across a P.D. (potential difference) or in parallel with a component instead of in series, the small internal resistance will permit a very large current to flow through the meter. This will most certainly damage the meter severely and perhaps the circuit as well.

On meters with manual range selection, start with the highest current setting and work your way down.

Current measurement procedures

Follow the steps below to measure current:

1. Turn off the power to the circuit that will be measured.
2. Open the circuit by disconnecting or unsoldering a connection at a point where you wish to measure current.
3. Select the DC or AC amps function by turning the function switch to DC or AC amps.
4. Plug the test probes into the appropriate probe jacks. Note that the jacks used may not be the same ones used to measure volts.
5. Connect the tips of the probes across the break in the circuit so that the current to be measured flows through the meter. Note that this is a series connection. Never connect the ammeter in parallel with the source or load, as this will cause a short circuit and damage the meter.
6. Turn the circuit power back on.
7. View the reading on the display unit. Be sure to note the unit of measurement.
8. Switch power off and disconnect meter leads from the circuit.

9. If testing is finished at this test point, restore the circuit by reclosing the connection. When current measurements are complete, turn the function switch to the OFF position and remove the test leads.

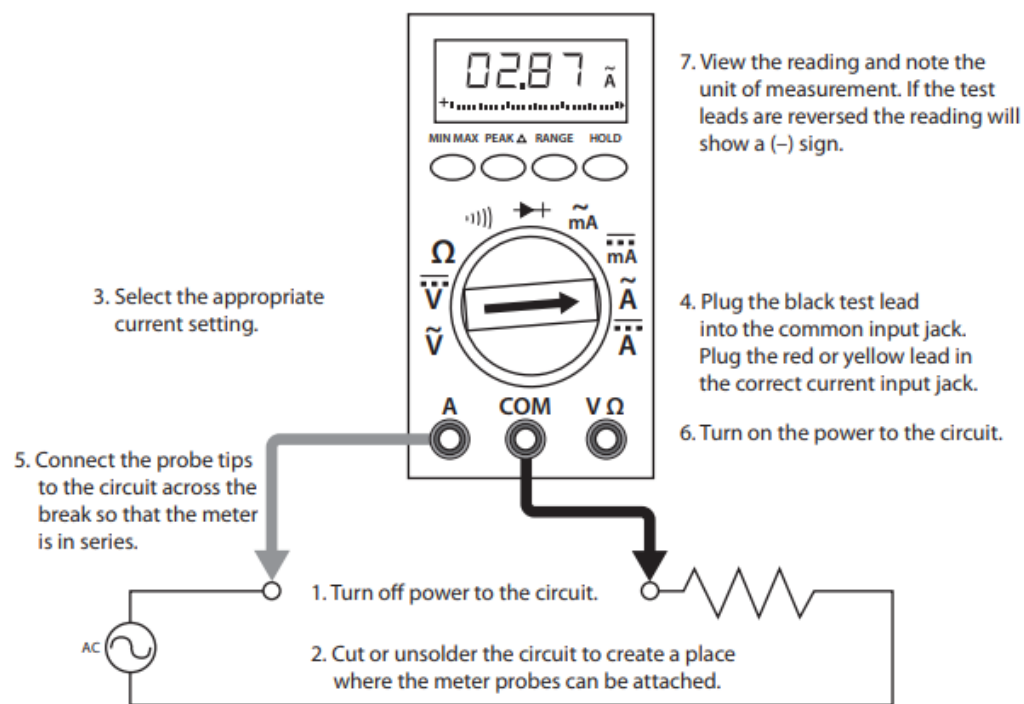
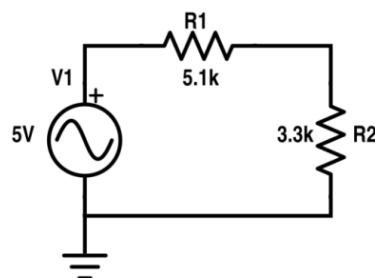


Figure 4 Using a DMM to measure current

Lab Tasks:

1. Measure Current between R1 and R2, and Voltage across R1, R2.



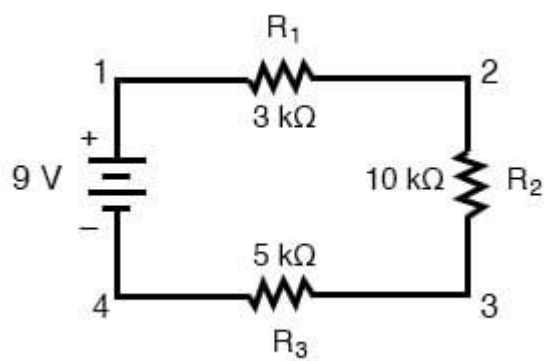
Practical Values:

R1 Voltage	R2 Voltage	Current

Theoretical Values:

R1 Voltage	R2 Voltage	Current

2. Measure Current at node 2 and 3 and Voltage across R1, R2, R3.



Practical Values:

R1 Voltage	R2 Voltage	R3 Voltage	Current at node 2	Current at node 3

Theoretical Values:

R1 Voltage	R2 Voltage	R3 Voltage	Current at node 2	Current at node 3

Post Lab Questions:

1. Define energy.

2. Define power.

3. What is charge?

4. What is circuit?

5. What is the role of a resistor in the series circuit?

6. What is the voltage divider rule?

7. What are the features of the series circuit?

8. Differentiate between the internal circuit of voltmeter and ammeter.

9. In which combination we connect DMM to measure current and voltages.
